

gasoline counterparts. With innovative solutions, such as solar rooftops, and open access renewable power for charging stations, EV usage can become completely carbon neutral as this ecosystem develops. Therefore, the agenda for the next five years would be to focus on accelerating the adoption of EVs.

Over the past four years, India has rapidly grown an EV market, with over 2 million electric two-wheelers, three-wheelers and cars on Indian roads. There is a strong aspiration for EVs in select pockets of India, with 70% of Tier I car customers contemplating electric cars for their next vehicle, surpassing the global average of 52%. The central government too has implemented a strong set of initiatives for the promotion of EVs, through GST reduction, FAME II incentives, and PLI schemes. State governments have also supported with road tax and registration waivers, and by establishing charging infrastructure through discoms. However, given India's late start in EVs, vehicle penetration is still very low.

By 2029, India should target 25-30% adoption of EVs across categories, which would mean an annual demand of 1.5-2 million cars and 4-5 million two-wheelers. Developing a local supply chain for EVs would create a scale manufacturing base in India, which could become a global export hub as well.

The Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship estimates that the EV industry can create 10 million direct jobs and 50 million indirect jobs by 2030. In addition, India will generate valuable intellectual property in EVs and components, which can trigger a wave of innovation and seed new industries in the country.



BY 2029, INDIA SHOULD TARGET 25-30% ADOPTION OF EVs ACROSS MULTIPLE CATEGORIES, OR ANNUAL DEMAND OF 1.5-2 MILLION PASSENGER CARS

The path to 30% EV penetration in new vehicle sales requires significant mainstream adoption. Customer studies indicate that awareness and accessibility of charging infrastructure is the primary hurdle. While 90% of current EV owners charge at home in their own private parking space, not all vehicle owners in India have their own private parking space. Mass deployment of chargers across residential and commercial buildings will drive greater consumer confidence in charging availability and accessibility. The government, municipalities, property owners, charge point operators and OEMs should come together to drive this

growth over the next few years.

In addition, there is also a need for creating greater awareness of EVs among customers and policy-makers. While EV prices will reach parity with ICE vehicles over the next several years, myth-busting is necessary. In addition, EV adoption should become a key aspect of sustainability strategies of all major corporates.

In summary, by focussing on EV adoption, India can become a global leader in the fight against climate change. **BT**

The author is MD of Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles & Tata Passenger Electric Mobility. Views are personal